

Fashion Magazine Editor

Installation guide for macOS and Windows

This guide explains what to install on your computer and how to start the Fashion Magazine Editor app. Follow the steps in order and do not skip any. At the end, the app runs on your computer and opens in your web browser.

What you need

- A Mac with an **Apple Silicon chip** (M1, M2, M3 or M4), or a **64-bit Windows 10 or 11** PC.
- About **3 GB of free disk space** and a stable internet connection.
- Your **OpenRouter API key**. It starts with **sk-or-**. If you do not have one, ask a Teaching Assistant.
- About **30 minutes** for the first installation. Starting the app again later takes about one minute.

How to read this guide

Every step that differs between the two systems has a **macOS** part and a **Windows** part. Only follow the part for your computer.

Text in a blue box is a command. Type it (or copy and paste it) into the terminal exactly as shown and press **Enter**. Run the commands of a box one line at a time, in order.

Overview

Step	What you do
1	Check your computer and open a terminal
2	Install Python 3.13
3	Download and unzip the app
4	Create and activate a virtual environment
5	Install the required packages
6	Start the app and open it in your browser
7	Enter your OpenRouter API key
8	Stop the app and start it again later
9	Troubleshooting

1 Check your computer and open a terminal

Check your computer

macOS

1. Click the **Apple menu** in the top left corner of the screen and choose **About This Mac**.
2. Look at the line **Chip**. If it says **Apple M1, M2, M3** or **M4**, your Mac is supported.
3. If you see **Processor** with **Intel** instead, your Mac cannot run this app, because the AI library it uses (PyTorch) no longer supports Intel Macs. Use the web app at the end of the Colab project notebook instead, or ask a Teaching Assistant.

Windows

1. Press the **Windows key**, type **About your PC** and press **Enter**.
2. Under **Device specifications**, check that **System type** says **64-bit operating system, x64-based processor**.

Open a terminal

The terminal is a window where you type commands. Keep it open during the whole installation.

macOS

1. Press **Cmd + Space** to open Spotlight.
2. Type **Terminal** and press **Enter**.

Windows

1. Press the **Windows key** and type **PowerShell**.
2. Click **Windows PowerShell**. You do not need to run it as administrator.

Important for Windows users

All Windows commands in this guide are written for **PowerShell**. Do not use the older **Command Prompt** (cmd.exe), because some commands are different there.

2 Install Python 3.13

The app needs Python 3.13. First check if it is already installed. If the check succeeds, skip to Step 3.

Check if Python 3.13 is installed

macOS

```
python3.13 --version
```

Windows

```
py -3.13 --version
```

If the answer is **Python 3.13.** followed by a number (for example **Python 3.13.2**), Python is installed. Go to Step 3. If you see an error such as **command not found**, **is not recognized** or **No suitable Python runtime found**, install Python as described below.

Install Python on macOS

1. Open <https://www.python.org/downloads/macos/> in your browser.
2. Under **Stable Releases**, find the newest **Python 3.13** release (for example Python 3.13.9) and click **Download macOS 64-bit universal2 installer**. Do not pick Python 3.14 or newer.
3. Open the downloaded **.pkg** file from your Downloads folder. Click **Continue** on every screen, click **Agree**, then **Install**, and enter your Mac password when asked.
4. When the installation finishes, a Finder window with the folder **Python 3.13** opens. Double-click the file **Install Certificates.command** in that folder. A terminal window opens, runs for a few seconds and prints **update complete**. You can then close that window. This step lets Python download files securely.
5. Close your terminal window completely (**Cmd + Q**), open a new one as in Step 1, and run the check again:

macOS

```
python3.13 --version
```

Expected answer: Python 3.13 followed by a number.

Install Python on Windows

1. Open <https://www.python.org/downloads/windows/> in your browser.
2. Under **Stable Releases**, find the newest **Python 3.13** release and click **Download Windows installer (64-bit)**. Do not pick Python 3.14 or newer.
3. Open the downloaded **.exe** file. On the first screen, tick the box **Add python.exe to PATH** at the bottom of the window. Then click **Install Now** and click **Yes** if Windows asks for permission.
4. On the last screen, if you see the option **Disable path length limit**, click it and confirm with **Yes**. Then click **Close**.
5. Close PowerShell, open a new PowerShell window as in Step 1, and run the check again:

Windows

```
py -3.13 --version
```

Expected answer: Python 3.13 followed by a number.

3 Download and unzip the app

You will place the app in your **home folder**, so that every command in this guide works without changes.

1. Open the course website and go to **Weekend 3**. On the Saturday schedule, find the row **12:00 Project intro: Fashion magazine editor** and click **App**. The file **fashion-magazine-editor.zip** is saved in your Downloads folder.
2. Unzip it. **macOS**: double-click the ZIP file. **Windows**: right-click the ZIP file, choose **Extract All**, then click **Extract**.
3. Open the extracted folders until you see the file **Installation Guide.pdf** and the folder **app** together. The folder that contains these two is called **Fashion-Magazine-Editor**. On Windows it is usually one level deeper, inside a folder named **fashion-magazine-editor**.
4. Move the folder **Fashion-Magazine-Editor** into your home folder. **macOS**: in Finder press **Shift + Cmd + H** to open your home folder and drag the folder into it. **Windows**: in File Explorer, click the address bar, type **%USERPROFILE%**, press **Enter**, and drag the folder into that window.
5. Do not rename the folder. Its name must stay exactly **Fashion-Magazine-Editor**.

Windows: why not the Documents folder?

On many Windows PCs the Documents folder is synchronised with OneDrive. OneDrive then tries to upload thousands of files from the virtual environment, which slows down your PC and can break the installation. Your home folder is not synchronised.

Check that the files are in the right place

Go to the app folder and list its contents:

macOS

```
cd ~/Fashion-Magazine-Editor/app
ls
```

Windows

```
cd $HOME\Fashion-Magazine-Editor\app
dir
```

You should see `backend`, `Data`, `templates` and `requirements.txt`. If you get an error such as **No such file or directory** or **Cannot find path**, the folder is not in your home folder or has a different name. Repeat this step.

4 Create and activate a virtual environment

A virtual environment is a private folder named `venv` that holds all the packages of the app, separate from the rest of your computer. You create it once.

Create the virtual environment (only once)

macOS

```
cd ~/Fashion-Magazine-Editor/app
python3.13 -m venv venv
```

Windows

```
cd $HOME\Fashion-Magazine-Editor\app
py -3.13 -m venv venv
```

The command prints nothing when it succeeds. A new folder `venv` now exists inside `app`.

Activate the virtual environment (every time you open a new terminal)

macOS

```
source venv/bin/activate
```

Windows

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope Process -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -Force
.\venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
```

The first line allows PowerShell to run the activation script in this window only. It does not change any setting of your computer.

When the environment is active, your prompt starts with `(venv)`. Check that the right Python is used. From now on the command is simply `python` on both systems:

Both

```
python --version
```

Expected answer: Python 3.13 followed by a number.

Always check for (venv)

Every command from Step 5 onwards must run with the environment active. If `(venv)` is missing at the start of the prompt, run the activation command above again from the `app` folder.

5 Install the required packages

With `(venv)` visible and inside the `app` folder, run these two commands one after the other. They are the same on macOS and Windows:

Both

```
python -m pip install --upgrade pip
python -m pip install -r requirements.txt
```

The second command downloads and installs about 75 packages, including PyTorch, Flask, OpenCV and Transformers. It downloads between 300 MB and 1 GB and usually takes **5 to 15 minutes**, depending on your internet connection. Lots of text scrolls by; this is normal. Do not close the terminal while it runs.

The installation succeeded when the last lines start with **Successfully installed** and you get the prompt back without a red **ERROR** line. A yellow **notice** or **WARNING** line is not a problem.

If the installation stops with an error

The most common message is **No matching distribution found for torch==2.10.0**. It means the virtual environment was created with the wrong Python version, or you are on an Intel Mac. Check `python --version` inside the environment. If it does not show Python 3.13, delete the `venv` folder and repeat Step 4 with Python 3.13. See Step 9 for more problems and fixes.

6 Start the app and open it in your browser

The app must be started from the `backend` folder inside `app`. With `(venv)` visible, run:

macOS

```
cd ~/Fashion-Magazine-Editor/app/backend
python main.py
```

Windows

```
cd $HOME\Fashion-Magazine-Editor\app\backend
python main.py
```

What you will see

- The **first start takes 2 to 5 minutes**, because the app downloads two AI models (about 700 MB) that it keeps for later. Later starts take about one minute.

- You see loading messages such as **[BERT] Model ready.** and **fashion-CLIP loaded.** They may appear twice. This is normal.
- When the app is ready, the terminal shows **Running on http://127.0.0.1:5001.**
- A red line **WARNING: This is a development server** is also normal and can be ignored.

Open the app

1. Open a web browser (Chrome, Firefox, Edge or Safari).
2. Type **http://127.0.0.1:5001** into the address bar and press **Enter**.
3. The page **Fashion Generator** opens, with a form on the left and the text **Your article will appear here** on the right.

Keep the terminal open

The terminal runs the app. If you close it, the app stops and the page no longer works. Leave it open while you use the app.

7 Enter your OpenRouter API key

The app needs your key before it can generate anything.

1. At the top of the left sidebar, click into the field **OpenRouter API Key**.
2. Paste your key. It starts with **sk-or-v1-**. The key stays hidden while you type; click the eye symbol next to the field to show it.
3. Click **Save Key**. The app checks the key with OpenRouter, which does not use any credits.
4. When the key is accepted, the text **Key saved for this session** appears below the button. The app is now ready to use.

The key is kept in memory only. After you stop and restart the app you enter it again, or you store it in a file as described below.

Optional: store the key in a .env file

This saves you from entering the key after every restart. Open a **second** terminal window (the first one is running the app), go to the **app** folder (not **backend**) and run the command for your system. Replace **sk-or-v1-your-key** with your real key and keep the quotes.

macOS

```
cd ~/Fashion-Magazine-Editor/app
echo "OPENROUTER_API_KEY=sk-or-v1-your-key" > .env
```

Windows

```
cd $HOME\Fashion-Magazine-Editor\app
Set-Content -Path .env -Value "OPENROUTER_API_KEY=sk-or-v1-your-key" -Encoding ascii
```

The key is used the next time you start the app (Step 8). Never share this file and never upload it anywhere, because it contains your private key.

8 Stop the app and start it again later

Stop the app

Click into the terminal window that runs the app and press **Ctrl + C** (on macOS as well, not Cmd + C). The prompt comes back and the page in the browser stops working.

Start the app again

You do not need to repeat the installation. Open a new terminal and run these lines one at a time:

macOS

```
cd ~/Fashion-Magazine-Editor/app
source venv/bin/activate
cd backend
python main.py
```

Windows

```
cd $HOME\Fashion-Magazine-Editor\app
Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope Process -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -Force
.\venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
cd backend
python main.py
```

Then open **http://127.0.0.1:5001** in your browser and save your API key again, unless you created the `.env` file.

9 Troubleshooting

Find the message you see in the left column. If your problem is not listed, copy the last lines of the terminal and show them to a Teaching Assistant.

Problem or message	Solution
python3.13: command not found (macOS)	Python 3.13 is not installed, or the terminal was opened before the installation. Install it as in Step 2, close the terminal with Cmd + Q and open a new one.
'py' is not recognized, or No suitable Python runtime found (Windows)	Python 3.13 is not installed. Install it as in Step 2, then close PowerShell and open a new window.
running scripts is disabled on this system (Windows)	Run <code>Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope Process -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -Force</code> in the same window, then activate the environment again.
(venv) does not appear in the prompt	The environment is not active. Go to the <code>app</code> folder and run the activation command from Step 4.
No module named 'flask' (or another module)	The app was started without the active environment, or Step 5 did not finish. Activate the environment, run Step 5 again, then start the app.
No matching distribution found for torch==2.10.0	Wrong Python version or an Intel Mac. Inside the environment, <code>python --version</code> must show 3.13. Delete the <code>venv</code> folder and repeat Steps 4 and 5 with Python 3.13.

Problem or message	Solution
CERTIFICATE_VERIFY_FAILED or SSL error (macOS)	Open Finder, go to Applications, open the folder Python 3.13 and double-click Install Certificates.command. Then start the app again.
Errors mentioning a long file path, or Filename too long (Windows)	Run the Python 3.13 installer again, choose Modify, click Next, and on the last screen click Disable path length limit. Then repeat Steps 4 and 5. Keeping the app in your home folder also keeps paths short.
can't open file 'main.py' or No such file or directory	You are not in the <code>backend</code> folder. Run the <code>cd</code> command from Step 6 first.
Address already in use, or Port 5001 is in use	The app is already running in another terminal window. Use that window, or stop it there with Ctrl + C. If you cannot find it, restart your computer.
The browser shows This site can't be reached	The app is not running or still loading. Check the terminal and wait for Running on <code>http://127.0.0.1:5001</code> .
The first start seems to hang	On the first start the app downloads about 700 MB of models. Wait up to 5 minutes before you stop it.
OpenRouter rejected this key	The key was mistyped or is no longer valid. Paste it again without spaces before or after it.
No OpenRouter API key set	Enter your key in the sidebar and click Save Key (Step 7). If you use a <code>.env</code> file, check that it is in <code>app</code> and not in <code>backend</code> .
Error code 402 or Insufficient credits	Your OpenRouter account has no credits left. Contact a Teaching Assistant.

Quick reference

App folder: `Fashion-Magazine-Editor/app` in your home folder.

Start: activate the environment in `app`, go to `backend`, run `python main.py`.

App address: `http://127.0.0.1:5001`

Stop: Ctrl + C in the terminal that runs the app.